Phishing Detection & Awareness Report

Hackers are constantly targeting companies through the use of phishing, particularly emails. They use a variety of social engineering tactics in an effort to get access to more information and access to a system. There are multiple ways a phishing email can be identified which we will explore in this awareness report.

Most companies have advanced systems which block suspicious emails however these may not be 100% accurate so it is important to be knowledgeable on how to determine if an email is a phishing email or not.

Prevention Guidelines

What To Do

- Verify sender details through official company websites
- Contact companies using publicly listed contact information
- Hover over links to inspect URLs before clicking
- Report suspicious emails to IT or security teams
- Delete suspicious emails immediately

What NOT To Do

- Do not click unknown links
- Do not download unexpected attachments
- Do not reply to suspicious emails
- Do not provide passwords or personal information

Phishing Email Examples & Analysis

Example 1 — Fake Payment Notification

P@yP@l
Invoice Record

Date: 11 March 2026
Invoice ID: PP-INV-20260309-8668219
Reference: 3F8A4C57B8

This statement confirms that an invoice has been recorded in connection with your P@yP@l account. The details below are provided for documentation and account reconciliation purposes.

Description	Qty	Amount (USD)
iP hone 17 P ro M ax (Red)	1	980.47
	Total	**980.47**

The invoice reflects a transaction request submitted through P@yP@l. Posting times may vary, and the corresponding entry may appear later in your account activity.

If this record does not match your personal records, please contact our fraud and billing Response Team Immediately calling by **1 970 303 2479** within 24 hours of receiving this massage.

This notification is generated automatically for statement purposes only.

Thank you for using **P@yP@l** to manage your payments securely.

P@yP@l Account Services

This message was identified as junk. We'll delete it after 29 days. It's not junk

The attachments on this message have been blocked for your safety. If you are certain that this message is safe, you can mark it as not Junk in order to access attachments.

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741 KB

Classification: Phishing

Indicators Identified:

- Brand impersonation using misspelled company name - PayPal is spelt as P@yP@l
- Fear-inducing language to cause panic
- Suspicious sender email domain
- Spelling and formatting errors

Risk Explanation:
The attacker attempts to pressure the victim into contacting a fake support team, potentially leading to theft of personal and financial information.

Billing department notice

MC MARICHU CANDELA<marichu.candela@depedcaloocan.com>
To: margemurray511974@groups.outlook.com
Reply Reply all Forward
Wed 2026/03/11 15:45

This message was identified as junk. We'll delete it after 26 days. It's not junk

This email has been scanned for viruses and malware, and may have been automatically archived by Mimecast, a leader in email security and cyber resilience. Mimecast integrates email defenses with brand protection, security awareness training, web security, compliance and other essential capabilities. Mimecast helps protect large and small organizations from malicious activity, human error and technology failure; and to lead the movement toward building a more resilient world. To find out more, visit our website.

Reply Reply all Forward

Example 2 — Fake Subscription Suspension

Your Amazon-Prime subscription expires soon 381483N*3226]

Un message d'erreur rouge sur une carte de paiement grise

Your Prime benefits have been suspended due to a billing issue

Hello,

We are unable to charge your payment method 6.99€ for your next 1-month Prime period. Your Prime benefits are currently suspended.

If you do not update your payment method within the next 6 days, your membership may be cancelled. Please update your payment information to regain access to your benefits.

Thank you,
Prime Customer Service

Update payment method

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Classification: Phishing

Indicators Identified:

- Urgent threat of membership cancellation
- Generic greeting
- Foreign language header unrelated to recipient region
- Email landed in spam folder
- Button containing hidden malicious link
- Suspicious website domain when hovering over link - .html

Risk Explanation:
The embedded button redirects users to a fake website designed to steal login credentials and payment details.

Example 3 — Fake Job Opportunity

MR

Meta | Recruitment <noreply@appsheet.com>

To: You

Dear Lusanda,

We are extending a highly selective invitation from the Meta Executive Recruitment Team to explore a pivotal leadership role: Senior Digital Marketing Manager. Your distinguished track record in strategic digital leadership and cultivating enduring digital growth has made your profile stand out, aligning perfectly with the profound impact we envision for this position.

At Meta, we are defining the future at the convergence of iconic brands and groundbreaking social technology. This is a unique opportunity for an influential leader to not only manage but redefine our most strategic digital initiatives, directly shaping our commercial success and market leadership.

About This Strategic Leadership Role: Senior Digital Marketing Manager

This executive role demands a visionary leader adept at driving significant enterprise growth through exceptional digital marketing prowess. As our Senior Digital Marketing Manager, you will be instrumental in:

- **Forging Visionary Digital Strategies:** Spearheading the development and expansion of deep, strategic digital marketing plans across Meta's diverse portfolio, translating evolving market needs into long-term value and growth.
- **Driving Commercial Excellence:** Owning and accelerating revenue growth, user acquisition, engagement, and retention within your digital campaigns, setting new benchmarks for digital marketing success.
- **Empowering High-Performance:** Leading, mentoring, and scaling a world-class team of digital marketing professionals, fostering a culture of strategic thinking, innovation, and unwavering data-driven advocacy.
- **Strategic Alignment & Influence:** Collaborating at the highest levels across Product, Marketing, Sales, and Operations to ensure seamless, integrated digital solutions that set industry standards.

Further details on this role's comprehensive strategic scope and executive-level expectations will be shared in a confidential preliminary discussion.

Our Vision: Innovate. Connect. Lead.

Classification: Suspicious (Likely Phishing)

Indicators Identified:

- Unexpected job offer without prior application
- Sender claims association with major company but uses unrelated platform
- Requests email reply to initiate further contact
- Possible tactic to collect personal information later
- Unofficial email address

Risk Explanation:
Attackers may use professional-looking emails to build trust before requesting confidential information.

Conclusion

Phishing remains one of the most common and dangerous cyber threats. While email security technologies continue to improve, attackers constantly evolve their techniques to bypass filters.

Understanding phishing indicators and following safe email practices significantly reduces the risk of becoming a victim.

User vigilance is a critical layer of cybersecurity defense.